

4 The Basics

Before we get to the basics of creating and configuring a Facebook application, we need to set up a developer environment, learn about the basic PHP skeleton, Facebook Markup Language (FBML) and the official PHP client-libraries. We also need some information about application authorisation and authentication, Facebook sessions and signatures and the configuration settings of the Facebook Developer application.

4.1 Setting a developer environment

Facebook provides the official PHP client libraries that you can download from its source code repository <http://svn.facebook.com/svnroot/platform/clients/packages/facebook-platform.tar.gz> and extract using any archiving tool such as WinRAR. Facebook officially supports PHP and Java client libraries, and ASP.net by its collaborated project with Microsoft - <http://www.codeplex.com/FacebookToolkit>. The unofficial libraries of several other programming languages can also be found on the Facebook Developers Wiki <http://wiki.developers.facebook.com>. This shall be your first step towards making a Facebook app. This client library contains all the resources required for your application to connect to the Facebook platform, encapsulate the standard application behaviour and access the API functions using PHP. It is nothing, but a set of three files namely,

- facebook_api_restlib.php – It lets you implement the FacebookRestClient class that provides raw HTTP access to the Facebook REST API.
- facebook.php – It lets you implement standard Facebook web-application behaviour in your application.
- facebook_desktop.php - It lets you implement standard Facebook desktop-application behaviour in your application.

Quick Start

Sometimes it's easier to learn by seeing something in action. That's why we've provided you with a sample application you can dive right into.

 **Download the Client Library**

This package has all the files that make up the official PHP Client Library, as well as a sample application.

More Helpful Links

- Platform Documentation
- Anatomy of a Facebook Application
- Code Samples
- Test Console (API, FBML, Feed)
- Unofficial Client Libraries

Download the client libraries from the same application summary page